



Reviews That Actually Get You Found — and Chosen

How to build a review strategy that ranks you higher on Google, gets you cited by ChatGPT, and converts hesitant customers into confirmed bookings

By the end of this guide: You'll have a simple repeatable system for collecting reviews that serve double duty — boosting your local ranking AND feeding AI tools the content they need to recommend you by name.

16–20%

of your local ranking comes from review signals

58%

of ChatGPT local recommendations reference review content

100%

of Perplexity local queries pull live review data

What you'll learn in this module

Reviews are the most misunderstood asset in local business marketing. Most businesses treat them as a vanity metric — nice to have, hard to get, occasionally annoying when negative. This module reframes that completely.

By the end, you'll understand why reviews are a *searchable content layer* about your business — and why the words your customers write are now being read by AI tools to decide whether to recommend you.

1

Why reviews affect your ranking — and exactly how much

The five review signals Google measures and how each one contributes to your Local Pack position.

2

How AI tools read your reviews — not just your star rating

Why the text content of reviews matters as much as the score, and what ChatGPT and Perplexity extract from them.

3

The three-step system for getting reviews consistently

The exact sequence — verbal ask, WhatsApp follow-up, QR code — that converts 40–60% of satisfied customers.

4

How to write review responses that double as SEO content

The formula for responses that naturally include service keywords and location — indexed by Google and read by AI.

5

Handling negative reviews without making things worse

A word-for-word response structure that defuses bad reviews and impresses the next potential customer who reads them.

Reviews are no longer just social proof. They're a data feed.

THINK OF IT THIS WAY

Your Google reviews are like a constantly updated Wikipedia article about your business — written entirely by your customers, publicly visible, indexed by search engines, and now read directly by AI tools when someone asks "who should I call?" The difference is: you didn't write it, but you can absolutely influence it.

In the early days of Google, reviews were primarily a **trust signal**. A high star rating made you look credible. Low ratings made you look suspect. The number and recency of reviews nudged your ranking. That was about it.

In 2026, reviews do something fundamentally different. They are **indexed content** — searchable text that describes your business in the words of real people who've experienced it. Google reads every word of every review. ChatGPT reads every word of every review. Perplexity reads every word of every review.

This means a review that says "fixed our leaking radiator the same day, was on time, charged exactly what he quoted, would absolutely recommend for any plumbing work in Harrogate" is doing something far more powerful than boosting your star rating. It's telling every AI tool that encounters it: this business handles emergency plumbing, operates in Harrogate, arrives on time, is honest about pricing, and is highly recommended. That review is indexing information about you that you never wrote.

The businesses winning in AI local search right now aren't the ones with the fanciest websites or the biggest budgets. They're the ones who've figured out how to generate a steady stream of detailed, relevant, recent reviews — and how to respond to them in a way that adds even more value.

This module shows you exactly how to do both.

Section 1: Why reviews affect your ranking — and exactly how much

Google's local ranking algorithm weighs several categories of signals. Review signals — taken together — account for between **16 and 20% of your total Local Pack ranking weight**. That makes them the second largest controllable factor after your Google Business Profile (32%).

But "review signals" isn't a single number. Google measures five distinct components:

Volume

Total lifetime reviews

Velocity

How recent and frequent

Rating

Your average star score

Response

% you've replied to

Keywords

Words reviewers use

Volume: the floor you need to reach

Review volume is the baseline. Without enough reviews, the other signals can't do their work. The benchmark varies by competition level:

- ✓ **Rural or niche:** 15–30 reviews at 4.0+ is often enough to appear in the top 3
- ✓ **Mid-sized town, common trade:** 40–80 reviews at 4.3+ to compete reliably
- ✓ **Major city, competitive category:** 100+ reviews at 4.4+ with strong recent velocity

QUICK BENCHMARK

Search Google for your exact trade and town right now. Look at the top three Local Pack results and count their reviews. That's your actual target — not a general guideline.

Velocity: recent trust beats historical trust

A business with 200 reviews from three years ago is algorithmically weaker than a competitor with 60 reviews and 12 in the last 90 days. Google weights recency heavily because current reviews signal a currently active, currently trusted business.

The practical implication: you need a system that generates reviews *continuously* — not a burst campaign every year. One new review per week is a realistic, sustainable target for most local businesses and enough to maintain strong velocity signals.

Rating: quality over perfection

A 4.9 average with 12 reviews is weaker than a 4.4 average with 180 reviews. Why? Because Google (and AI tools) apply statistical confidence — a large sample size with a slightly lower score is more trustworthy than a small sample with a perfect score.

You don't need 5.0. You need a genuine, well-maintained score above 4.3 with enough volume to be statistically meaningful. The obsession with perfect scores often leads businesses to stop asking unhappy customers for feedback, which creates a biased sample that Google can detect as suspicious.

Response rate: one of the most overlooked signals

Google tracks what percentage of your reviews you've responded to. Businesses that respond to 100% of reviews outperform those that respond to none — even when total review counts are the same. The reason is straightforward: Google sees responses as evidence of an engaged, active business. An unanswered review pile looks abandoned.

COMMON MISTAKE

Many businesses respond to positive reviews but ignore negative ones, hoping they'll fade. In fact, ignoring a negative review is often more damaging than the review itself. Every unanswered complaint is visible to every future potential customer — and to Google's algorithm.

Keyword content: the signal most businesses don't know exists

When customers write reviews, the words they use are indexed by Google as content about your business. A cluster of reviews mentioning "emergency call-out", "fair price", and "Harrogate" tells Google those concepts are associated with your business — even though you never wrote those words yourself. This is why detailed reviews outperform emoji-only responses.

Section 2: How AI tools read your reviews — not just your star rating

THINK OF IT THIS WAY

When ChatGPT is asked "who's the best roofer in Leeds?", it doesn't look up a ranking table. It reads everything it can find about roofers in Leeds — including your reviews — and synthesises a recommendation based on what the evidence says. Your reviews are part of that evidence.

ChatGPT uses review content in **58% of local business recommendations**. Perplexity references review data in **100% of local business queries**. What these tools extract from reviews goes well beyond the star rating:

- ✓ **Service types** — "replaced our flat roof", "fitted a new boiler", "cut and coloured my hair" tells AI what specific jobs you handle
- ✓ **Service characteristics** — "turned up on time", "clear quote upfront", "kept the area tidy" tells AI about your working style
- ✓ **Location signals** — "came to us in Harrogate", "covered our shop in the city centre" adds geographic data AI associates with your business
- ✓ **Problem resolution** — "had a small issue but they sorted it straight away" tells AI you handle problems professionally
- ✓ **Customer type** — "as a landlord I need reliable tradespeople" tells AI you're trusted by landlords specifically

This is why a business with 40 detailed, descriptive reviews can outperform a competitor with 200 star-only responses in AI recommendations. **The information density of your reviews matters.**

The review quality spectrum

Not all reviews are equal to AI:

Weak: "5 stars. Would recommend." — Almost no extractable information. AI learns nothing about your business.

Strong: "Came the same afternoon when our boiler stopped working in January. Fixed it in 90 minutes, charged £95 which was exactly what he quoted. Will use again and recommend to anyone in Harrogate needing a plumber." — AI extracts: emergency service, heating, fast response, transparent pricing, Harrogate location, strongly positive sentiment.

Can you influence what customers write?

You can't tell customers what to write — and you shouldn't try. But you can **prompt them in ways that naturally produce more descriptive responses**.

When you ask for a review, instead of "please leave us a Google review", try:

MORE EFFECTIVE ASK

*"We'd really appreciate it if you could leave us a Google review — **even just a sentence or two about the job and what you thought of the service** would be brilliant. It really helps people find us when they're looking for the same kind of work."*

The phrase "a sentence or two about the job" is a gentle prompt to write something descriptive rather than just tapping five stars. You're not telling them what to say — you're giving them a format that's comfortable to write.

You can also provide a brief summary in your review request:

WHATSAPP FOLLOW-UP TEMPLATE

*"Thanks for having us today for the **bathroom installation**! Really glad it went well. If you've got a moment, a Google review would mean the world to us — here's the direct link: [link]. Even a quick mention of the job is really helpful. Thanks again "*

Notice: you mentioned the job type naturally. The customer now has a mental anchor — they're more likely to include "bathroom installation" in their review. That's the keyword signal that serves you.

GOOGLE'S RULES ON THIS

You can ask customers for reviews. You can suggest they mention the job type. What you cannot do: offer incentives for positive reviews, ask only your happy customers (this is called "review gating" and is against policy), or ask anyone to write a fake review. Breaking these rules risks suspension of your Google Business Profile.

Section 3: The three-step system for getting reviews consistently

Most businesses don't have a review problem — they have a **system problem**. Asking for reviews happens randomly, inconsistently, and usually at the wrong moment. The businesses that dominate review counts have made the ask automatic.

Here's the three-step sequence that converts 40–60% of satisfied customers:

Step 1: The verbal ask at the moment of completion

The highest-converting moment is when the customer is at peak satisfaction — the job is done, they can see the result, and you're standing right there.

Say exactly this: *"Everything look good? We'd really appreciate it if you could leave us a quick Google review — it takes two minutes and really helps people find us. I'll send you the link now."*

That last sentence is critical. Don't just ask — commit to sending the link immediately. This sets up Step 2 and removes the excuse "I'll do it later" (which means never).

WHY IT WORKS

You're asking at the precise moment the customer is happiest. You're removing friction by sending the link. You're giving them a clear, easy action. Three seconds of courage on your part converts to a permanent review on Google.

Step 2: WhatsApp or text within 2 hours

Send the direct review link within 2 hours of completing the job — not 48 hours later when the moment has faded. Review conversion drops by over 60% after the first 24 hours.

Save this as a phone template so you're never typing it fresh:

TEMPLATE — SAVE TO YOUR PHONE NOW

"Hi [Name], thanks for having us today! Really glad the [JOB TYPE] went well. If you have a moment, a Google review would mean a lot to us — here's the direct link: [DIRECT REVIEW LINK]. Even a couple of sentences about the job is brilliant. Thanks again 😊"

Step 3: QR code on everything physical

For customers who pay in person, hand over invoices, or visit your premises — a QR code that links directly to your review page is the bridge between the verbal ask and the action.

- ✓ Print it on your invoice or receipt ("Enjoyed our service? Leave us a review!")
- ✓ Put it on your business card — on the back with a simple call to action
- ✓ Add a vinyl sticker to your van or company vehicle
- ✓ Print an A5 card for your workshop counter, reception, or front door

How to get your direct Google review link

A direct link takes the customer straight to the review box — no searching required. Every step you remove doubles conversion.

- 1 Go to business.google.com and log in to your Google Business Profile
- 2 Click "Ask for reviews" in the right-hand column of your dashboard
- 3 Google generates a short shareable link — copy it
- 4 Go to bit.ly (free) and paste the link to create a shorter version
- 5 Test it on your phone to confirm it opens the review box directly
- 6 Save the link in your phone's notes and as a message template

DON'T SKIP THE SHORTENING STEP

Google's review links can be very long. A long URL looks suspicious in a WhatsApp message and reduces click-through. The bit.ly shortened version looks clean, professional, and is much more likely to be tapped.

What about email follow-up?

Email works but converts significantly lower than WhatsApp and verbal asks — typically 5–10% versus 30–50% for the direct approach. Use email as a backup for customers where you don't have a mobile number, or for e-commerce / service businesses where in-person contact doesn't happen. If you use email, send within 24 hours and keep the message to three sentences maximum.

Section 4: How to write review responses that double as SEO content

THINK OF IT THIS WAY

Your review responses are public content — visible to every prospective customer and indexed by Google and AI tools. Most businesses treat them as courtesy acknowledgements. Treat them as micro-content that describes your business, and they become one of the highest-value things you write.

When you respond to a review, Google indexes your response. AI tools read your response. Future customers read your response. A thoughtful response that naturally includes your trade type and location is worth far more than "Thanks so much!"

The response formula for positive reviews

Structure: **Thank** → **Acknowledge the job** → **Location reference** → **Future invitation**

GENERIC RESPONSE (LOW VALUE)

"Thank you so much for your kind words! Really appreciate it. See you next time! 😊"

SEO-STRUCTURED RESPONSE (HIGH VALUE)

*"Thank you for the lovely review, James! We're really pleased the **emergency boiler repair** went smoothly — it was a cold week for it to pack in. We cover all **gas and heating work across Harrogate and the surrounding villages**, so don't hesitate to call if anything comes up in future. Really appreciated."*

The second response naturally contains: the job type (emergency boiler repair), the trade (gas and heating), the location (Harrogate), and a warm, human tone. All of that is indexed content. You didn't write a keyword-stuffed marketing paragraph — you wrote a genuine human response that happens to contain the right information.

Building a library of response templates

You don't need to write a bespoke response to every review. Build a library of 8–10 templates that cover different job types, then personalise with the customer's name and any specific detail they mentioned. This takes 2 minutes per review rather than 10.

TEMPLATE — KITCHEN FITTING

*"Thank you for taking the time to leave a review, [Name]! Really pleased the **kitchen installation** came together so well — it's a big job and great to hear you're happy with the finish. If you ever need any **kitchen or bathroom work in [TOWN]**, we're always here. Thanks again."*

TEMPLATE — HAIR AND BEAUTY

*"So glad you loved your **[service]**, [Name]! It was lovely to have you in the salon. Looking forward to seeing you for your next **appointment in [TOWN]** — let us know if you want to book anything in advance. "*

TEMPLATE — ACCOUNTING/PROFESSIONAL

*"Thank you, [Name] — really appreciate you taking the time to leave a review. Glad we were able to help get your **[service, e.g. tax return]** sorted efficiently. If you need anything else over the coming year, you know where we are. We work with **businesses and sole traders across [TOWN and region]**."*

Notice the pattern in every template: a specific reference to the job type, a natural location mention, and a warm but professional close. The bracketed words are the ones you personalise per response.

SET A 48-HOUR RULE

Set a recurring reminder to check for new reviews every Monday and Thursday. Responding within 48 hours maximises the freshness signal Google reads — and shows prospective customers you're engaged and attentive. Businesses that respond within 24 hours see measurably higher enquiry rates from review-influenced searchers.

Section 5: Handling negative reviews without making things worse

THINK OF IT THIS WAY

A negative review with a professional, empathetic response is less damaging to your business than a negative review with no response at all. The prospective customer reading it isn't just judging whether something went wrong — they're judging how you handle it when things do.

Negative reviews are inevitable. The businesses that handle them well actually convert more new customers than those with no negative reviews at all — because a thoughtful response demonstrates accountability in a way that five-star unanimity cannot.

The four rules before you type a single word

- 1 Wait 24 hours.** Never respond when you're angry. A defensive or argumentative response to a bad review is visible forever and far more damaging than the review itself.
- 2 Read it twice.** Is there anything legitimate in the complaint? If yes, acknowledge it. Denying valid feedback publicly makes you look dishonest.
- 3 Remember who you're writing for.** You're not really responding to the unhappy customer — you're responding to the next 200 potential customers who will read this exchange. Write for them.
- 4 Take the resolution offline.** Offer a phone number or email to continue the conversation. Never argue or explain at length in a public reply — it escalates and looks defensive.

The word-for-word negative review response structure

Acknowledge → Apologise → Act → Offline

STRUCTURE IN ACTION

*"Thank you for leaving feedback — I'm really sorry to hear this wasn't the experience we aim for. **We take all concerns seriously and want to make this right.** Please give us a call on [NUMBER] or drop us an email at [EMAIL] and I'll personally look into this for you. We always aim to resolve any issues quickly and fairly."*

What to say when the review is genuinely unfair

Sometimes reviews are from someone who got the wrong business, describes something that didn't happen, or is clearly a competitor acting in bad faith. The public response still follows the same structure — calm, professional, brief. And separately, you can flag the review to Google for removal if it clearly violates their policies.

RESPONSE TO A CASE OF MISTAKEN IDENTITY

"Thank you for your feedback. We've looked into this and we don't appear to have any record of your details in our system — it's possible this review was intended for a different business. If you'd like to check, please email us at [EMAIL] and we'll look into it straight away. We hope your issue is resolved soon."

RESPONSE TO AN EXAGGERATED/INACCURATE REVIEW

"Thank you for taking the time to leave feedback. Our records show we attended on [DATE] and [BRIEF FACTUAL NOTE — e.g. 'completed the work within the agreed timeframe']. We're sorry if the experience felt different from our account of it. Please call us on [NUMBER] — we always want the chance to resolve any concerns directly and fairly."

Note: in the second example, you've introduced a factual counter-point without arguing. You've also shown future customers that you maintain records and take things professionally. That's a trust signal for the readers watching this exchange.

When to try to get a review removed

Google allows you to flag reviews that violate their policies. Valid grounds include:

- ✓ The reviewer was never your customer
- ✓ The review contains hate speech, profanity, or threats
- ✓ The review is clearly spam or from a fake account
- ✓ The review contains personal information (phone numbers, addresses)
- ✓ The review is a conflict of interest (competitor, current employee)

To flag: click the three dots next to the review in your GBP dashboard → "Report review". Google

typically reviews flagged content within 3–7 days. Don't flag reviews simply because you disagree with them — this tactic fails and Google monitors abuse of the flagging system.

Section 6: Which other review platforms matter — and which don't

Google reviews are your primary focus — full stop. If you have limited time and energy, every minute spent on reviews should go toward Google first. But once your Google review base is healthy (50+ reviews, consistent velocity), building reviews on secondary platforms reinforces your AI search visibility in meaningful ways.

Platforms that AI tools reference for local business

- ✓ **Yelp UK** — Perplexity and ChatGPT both reference Yelp data for local business queries. If you're in a customer-facing trade (food, beauty, fitness, hospitality), Yelp reviews appear in AI answers regularly.
- ✓ **Facebook Reviews** — Facebook Business reviews are indexed by Google and cited by AI tools. Particularly relevant for service businesses with strong local Facebook presence.
- ✓ **Trustpilot** — For service businesses and e-commerce, Trustpilot reviews carry strong authority with AI tools. Trustpilot pages rank well independently, so a Trustpilot presence gives you an additional cited source.
- ✓ **Checkatrade / TrustATrader** — For UK trades (plumbing, electrical, roofing, landscaping), these are industry-specific directories with review functionality. ChatGPT references Checkatrade regularly in UK trade recommendations.
- ✓ **TripAdvisor** — For hospitality, accommodation, and tourist-facing businesses, TripAdvisor remains the primary review source cited by AI for location-based recommendations.

The multi-platform strategy

You don't need to actively manage five review platforms. The approach that works without overwhelming you:

- 1 Google is always Step 1 — ask every customer for a Google review
- 2 For your most relevant secondary platform, add a line to your review request: "If you'd also like to leave a review on [Checkatrade/Yelp/Facebook], that helps too!"
- 3 Set up profiles on all relevant platforms even if you only actively pursue Google and one other — an empty profile is better than no profile for AI citation consistency

Section 7: How to audit your current review signals

Before building a review system, it helps to know exactly where you stand. This audit takes 15 minutes and gives you a clear picture of your current review health across the signals Google and AI tools actually measure.

The 5-point review audit

- ✓ **Volume check** — How many Google reviews do you currently have? Search your trade + town and compare to Local Pack positions 1, 2, and 3. Note the gap.
- ✓ **Velocity check** — When was your most recent review? If it's more than 4 weeks ago, your velocity signal is weakening. How many reviews have you had in the last 90 days?
- ✓ **Rating check** — Is your average above 4.3? If below, look at the negative reviews to find the pattern. Is there a recurring complaint (response time? pricing clarity? a specific service?) that you can address operationally?
- ✓ **Response rate check** — Go to your GBP dashboard. How many of your reviews have a response? If it's less than 100%, work through the unanswered ones today. Even a late response is better than none.
- ✓ **Content quality check** — Read your last 20 reviews. How many contain job-specific detail versus just a star rating or single sentence? This tells you whether your current ask method is prompting descriptive responses.

What the audit tells you

If your velocity is low, the system in Section 3 fixes this. If your response rate is below 100%, today's task is clear. If your review content is thin, the prompting language in Section 3 addresses this. If your total volume is significantly behind competitors, you have a target and a timeframe — at one new review per week, you know how many weeks it takes to close the gap.

USE BRIGHTLOCAL'S FREE AUDIT

BrightLocal.com offers a free local search audit that checks your review count, rating, and presence across multiple platforms. Run it on yourself and on your top competitor — the comparison is often illuminating.

Section 8: Tracking your review progress — the numbers that matter

You don't need complex tools to track whether your review strategy is working. Three numbers, checked monthly, tell you everything.

The three numbers to track monthly

Total Count — growing toward your competitor benchmark?	Monthly new Velocity — are you adding at least 4 per month?	Average Rating — staying above 4.3?
---	---	---

Set a phone reminder for the first Monday of each month. Open Google Maps, search your business name, and note these three numbers in a simple note or spreadsheet. That's your entire tracking process.

Leading indicators vs lagging indicators

Review count and ranking position are **lagging indicators** — they reflect what you did in the past. The **leading indicator** to track is how consistently your team is asking for reviews. If the ask happens after every job, the count will follow. If the ask is happening sporadically, the count will plateau.

Consider a simple tally: how many review requests did we send this week? If the answer is zero in a week where you completed 12 jobs, you know exactly where the problem is — and it's not the review platform.

When to expect results

- ✓ **0–4 weeks:** Velocity signal improvement as new reviews arrive
- ✓ **4–8 weeks:** Visible movement in Local Pack positions if you were close to competitors
- ✓ **8–16 weeks:** Meaningful AI citation improvement as review content builds up
- ✓ **6+ months:** Competitive dominance in review signals if consistently applied

DON'T JUDGE BY RANKING POSITION ALONE

Local Pack ranking is also affected by proximity — which you can't control. You might do everything right and not see a dramatic shift in position for searches where your competitors are closer to the searcher. Track your review count and response rate as the primary success metrics — Local Pack visibility will reflect them over time.

Section 9: The 6 most common review mistakes — and how to avoid them

Mistake 1: Sending the review request too late

Sending a review request 48+ hours after the job is completed loses more than 60% of potential conversions. The customer has moved on, the job is no longer top of mind, and the emotional peak of satisfaction has faded. Ask within 2 hours of completion.

Mistake 2: Sending a link that takes too many steps

Asking someone to "search for us on Google and leave a review" involves at least four steps: open Google, search your name, find the reviews section, click write a review. Many people abandon this journey. A direct link removes all friction and takes the customer straight to the review box.

Mistake 3: Only asking your obviously happy customers

This is called review gating — pre-selecting who gets the review link based on whether you think they'll leave a positive review. It's against Google's terms of service, and Google's algorithm can detect unusual patterns (all positive, no variation in sentiment) that suggest manipulation. Ask consistently, not selectively.

Mistake 4: Responding with generic copy-paste replies

"Thank you for your review! We appreciate your business." repeated 40 times is visible to every customer reading your profile — and to AI tools that flag it as low-quality engagement. Use templates, but personalise each one with the customer's name and a reference to the job.

Mistake 5: Ignoring reviews for weeks at a time

Google shows timestamps on reviews and responses. A review from three weeks ago with no response tells prospective customers (and Google's algorithm) that you're not actively monitoring your presence. Check and respond twice per week as a minimum.

Mistake 6: Treating negative reviews as a PR crisis

A single negative review handled well is not a crisis. A single negative review handled badly (arguing, dismissing the customer, accusing them publicly) can cause real reputational damage. Stay calm, be brief, offer to resolve offline.

Section 10: Using your reviews to maximise AI search citations

Everything in this module so far improves your Google Local Pack ranking. This section covers the additional steps that take your reviews from a ranking signal to an active AI citation driver — because these two channels, while heavily overlapping, aren't identical.

Step 1: Add AggregateRating schema to your website

AggregateRating schema marks up your review score and count directly on your website — so AI tools can read your rating without cross-referencing Google. It looks like this in your page code:

```
"@type": "AggregateRating",  
"ratingValue": "4.8",  
"reviewCount": "127",  
"bestRating": "5"
```

This nested inside your LocalBusiness schema (covered in Module 1) tells every AI tool that your business has 127 reviews averaging 4.8 stars — without them needing to fetch the data from Google in real time.

Step 2: Feature selected reviews on your website

Displaying two or three real customer reviews on your homepage gives AI tools review content indexed directly on your own website — not just on Google's platform. Mark them up with **Review schema** (the individual review type within AggregateRating) so AI can extract them as structured citations.

Step 3: Reference reviews in your FAQ answers

In your FAQ section (covered in Module 1 schema and the next module on your website), include questions like "What do your customers say about you?" and answer with a synthesised version of genuine review feedback: "Our customers consistently highlight our same-day availability, fair pricing, and the fact that we leave the job site clean." This is SEO-rich, AI-citable, and credible because it reflects real review content.

Quick Wins Checklist

Tick these off in order. The top five will have the biggest immediate impact.

THIS WEEK

- ☐ Get your direct Google review link from business.google.com → "Ask for reviews"
- ☐ Shorten it using bit.ly and save as a message template on your phone
- ☐ Reply to every unanswered review on your profile — including old ones
- ☐ Ask three current or recent customers for a review today using the verbal + WhatsApp method
- ☐ Add your direct review link to your email signature

THIS MONTH

- ☐ Run the 5-point review audit (page 15) and note your current numbers
- ☐ Create a QR code from your review link and print it on invoices and business cards
- ☐ Build your response template library — 8 templates covering your main job types
- ☐ Set a twice-weekly reminder (Monday and Thursday) to check for new reviews and respond
- ☐ Set a monthly reminder to count your reviews and track velocity

FOR AI SEARCH VISIBILITY

- ☐ Add AggregateRating schema to your website with your current review count and average
- ☐ Add 2–3 featured reviews to your homepage and mark them up with Review schema
- ☐ Add a FAQ question about customer feedback and answer with synthesised review content
- ☐ Claim and complete your Yelp UK and Facebook Business reviews page

What's next in this series

You've now covered four of the five pillars of AI local search visibility:

- ✓ **Module 1:** Why Local Search Is Going AI — the landscape, the opportunity, the urgency
- ✓ **Module 2:** Your Google Business Profile — set up fully for the AI era
- ✓ **Module 3:** NAP Consistency — making every directory work together
- ✓ **Module 4:** Reviews — getting found and chosen (this module)

COMING UP — MODULE 5 OF 5

Your Website as an AI Signal — Structure, Schema, and the Content That Gets You Cited

Your website is the one thing you fully control — and it's the place where schema markup, FAQ content, and topical authority combine to create the clearest possible signal to AI tools. Module 5 covers the exact website structure, page-by-page schema strategy, and content framework that makes AI cite you by name. The module that ties the whole series together.

Everything covered in this series — GBP, citations, reviews, and your website — works as a connected system. Each pillar reinforces the others. A business with a complete GBP, consistent citations, strong reviews, and a well-structured website is significantly more likely to appear in AI local search recommendations than any single element alone can achieve.

That's the complete AI local search visibility framework. Module 5 closes the loop.

Resources mentioned in this module

Tools

- ✓ **business.google.com** — Your Google Business Profile dashboard. Use "Ask for reviews" to get your direct review link.
- ✓ **bit.ly** — Free link shortener for creating a clean review link to share via WhatsApp and text.
- ✓ **QR Code Generator (qr-code-generator.com or similar)** — Free tool to create a QR code from your review link for printed materials.
- ✓ **BrightLocal.com** — Free local search audit showing your review count, rating, and citation presence across platforms.
- ✓ **Google Rich Results Test (search.google.com/test/rich-results)** — Verify your AggregateRating schema is working correctly.
- ✓ **validator.schema.org** — Check your Review and AggregateRating JSON-LD code for syntax errors before publishing.

Platforms to build reviews on

- ✓ **Google Business Profile** — Primary. Always the first priority.
- ✓ **Yelp UK (yelp.co.uk)** — Claim your listing and activate reviews
- ✓ **Facebook Business** — Enable reviews in your Page settings
- ✓ **Checkatrade / TrustATrader** — UK trades: essential for AI trade recommendations
- ✓ **TripAdvisor** — Hospitality, accommodation, tourist-facing businesses
- ✓ **Trustpilot** — Service businesses, e-commerce, professional services

Further reading

- ✓ aisearchschool.com/articles — Free articles on AI local search, reviews, and schema markup
- ✓ support.google.com/business — Google's official GBP help centre, including review policies
- ✓ schema.org/AggregateRating — Full documentation for AggregateRating and Review schema

GET FOUND IN AI LOCAL SEARCH — COMPLETE SERIES

01

Why Local Search Is Going AI

The landscape, the opportunity, the urgency

02

Your Google Business Profile

Set up fully for the AI era

03

NAP Consistency

Make every directory work together

04

Reviews That Actually Get You Found — and Chosen

You are here ✓

05

Your Website as an AI Signal

Structure, schema, and the content that gets you cited

GET THE COMPLETE BUNDLE

All 5 modules · Full AI Local Search System

aisearchschool.com/guides